Choose firm, waxy potatoes that will keep their shape and texture in this deliciously savory soup. Cooking the beans until just *al dente* retains maximum taste and color.

beef and green bean soup

SERVES 6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 1 HR **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS

2 tbsp sunflower oil
1lb 2oz (500g) braising beef (from the shoulder), diced into ¾in (2cm) cubes
salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 onion, chopped
2–3 sprigs of thyme
1 quart (1 liter) vegetable stock
1 large potato, cut into chunks
9oz (250g) fresh green beans, trimmed and cut into small pieces
1–2 tbsp chopped fresh parsley (optional)

1 Heat the oil in a pan, season the cubed meat with salt and pepper, and add half the meat to the hot oil. Brown the meat until golden all over. Remove from the pan and repeat with the the next batch. When finished, remove all the meat from the pan, add the onion, and cook until softened.

2 Transfer the browned meat back to the pan, tie the thyme sprigs together with kitchen string, and add them to the pan with the stock. Bring to a boil, cover, and cook over medium heat for about 40 minutes.

3 Add the potato, bring back to a boil, cover, and cook for 10–15 minutes, or until just tender. Add the chopped beans and cook for 4–5 minutes, or until the beans are *al dente*.

4 Remove the thyme. Season to taste with salt and pepper, break up the meat pieces slightly, and sprinkle with parsley, if using, before serving.